Tamarind has long been used in Africa and in Southern Asia. The name tamarindus is of Arabian origin, which means **"dates of India"**. (tamar – dates; Indus – India).

Uses

It is used in flavouring sauces in the United States and Mexico. In India, the fruit pulp is major ingredients for many culinary preparations. Sweet tamarinds are sold as table fruits in India imported from Thailand and Malaysia.



Sambar – The World Inside

When we see the bowl of sambar, we can see the world inside. Mustard, Cumin and Coriander from Mediterranean, pepper from Western Ghats of India, turmeric from Southern Asia, chilly from South America, onion from Afganisthan, tamarind from Tropical Africa, tomato from South America, potato from Peru and Bolivia, lady's-finger from Africa, and redgram from South India make the Sambar as a global dish.

10.3 Fibres

Botanically a fiber is a long narrow and thick-walled cell. Plant fibres are classified according to their use (Table 10.3)

Table 10.3 Classification of fibres

S. No	Types of fibre	Uses	Example
1	Textile fibre	Manufacture of fabrics, netting and cordage.	Cotton, hemp, jute.
2	Brush fibre	Making brushes and brooms.	Palm fibres and brooms.
3	Plaiting fibre	Making hats, baskets, furniture.	Cane, Vitex and Lantana.
4	Filling fibre	Stuffing pillows, cushions and beds.	Silk cotton, Calotropis.

Cotton

Botanical name : *Gossypium* spp.

Family : Malvaceae

Cotton is the world's most important non-food commercial crop.

Origin and Area of cultivation: It is one of the oldest cultivated crops of the world. It has been cultivated for about 8000 years both in new world and in old world. Commercial cotton comes from four cotton species: two from the new world and two from the old world. (1) *G. hirsutum* (2) *G.barbadense* are the New world species and (3) *G. arboretum* (4) *G. herbaceum* are the old world species. In India cotton is cultivated in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

Uses

It is mainly used in the manufacturing of various textile, hosiery products, toys and is also used in hospitals.

Jute

Botanical name : *Corchorus* spp.

Family : Malvaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation: Jute is derived from the two cultivated species (1) *Corchorus capsularis* and (2) *C.olitorius* is of African origin whereas *C. capsularis,* is believed to be Indo-Burmese origin. It is an important cultivated commercial crop in Gangetic plains of India and Bangladesh.

Uses

It is one of the largest exported fibre material of India. The jute industry occupies an important place in the national economy of India. Jute is used for 'safe' packaging in view of being natural, renewable, bio-degradable and eco-friendly product. It is used in bagging and wrapping textile. About 75% of the jute produced is used for manufacturing sacks and bags. It is also used in manufacture of blankets, rags, curtains etc. It is also being used as a textile fibre in recent years.

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